

Cognitive Flexibility & Thought Challenging Workbook

A full workbook for challenging automatic thoughts, checking evidence, and developing balanced thinking.

Includes cognitive distortions, Socratic questions, proportion, perspective, self-talk, and behavioral experiments.

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Reminder

These workbooks are for self-reflection, therapeutic practice, and continued work between sessions. They are not a substitute for professional care, diagnosis, or medical advice.

Form 1

Identifying an Automatic Thought and Core Assumption

Spot the first thought and the assumption behind it.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

The thought

The thought I want to examine:

What emotion does it bring up?

What do I tend to do when I believe it?

Checking the thought

What supports this thought?

What does not support it?

What information may be missing?

Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 2

Evidence For and Against the Thought

Check whether a thought rests on the full picture or only one part.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

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Practice suggestion

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Form 3

Socratic Questions for Thought Challenging

Use focused questions to open a more flexible way of thinking.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

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Form 4

Cognitive Distortions and Rewording

Identify all-or-nothing thinking, mind reading, catastrophizing, and other patterns.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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The thought

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Checking the thought

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Flexible perspective

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What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 5

Proportion and Risk Reappraisal

Re-estimate danger, probability, and coping capacity.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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Flexible perspective

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What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 6

Alternative Perspectives

Practice seeing the same situation from several possible angles.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 7

A Mediating Thought Between Extremes

Build a thought that is neither harsh nor unrealistic.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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The thought

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Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 8

Supportive Self-Talk

Create inner language that supports action and steadiness.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

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What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 9

Challenging a Limiting Belief

Examine a belief that narrows choice and build a more flexible belief.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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The thought

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Checking the thought

What supports this thought?

What does not support it?

What information may be missing?

Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 10

Behavioral Experiment for a Thought

Plan a small safe experiment to test a thought.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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Checking the thought

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What information may be missing?

Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

Choose one question from this form and use it whenever the thought appears this week.

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Form 11

Trigger Response Script

Prepare a balanced response for recurring trigger situations.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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The thought

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Flexible perspective

What would I say to a friend in this situation?

What is another possible explanation?

What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

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Form 12

Balanced Thought and Next Plan

Summarize a more balanced thought and the next practical step.

What this form is for

To help examine thoughts without fighting them, suppressing them, or accepting them automatically as facts.

How to use it

Choose one specific situation or thought. Work slowly and answer only the questions that fit.

How convincing does the thought feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

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What part of the thought may be true but incomplete?

Balanced response

A more balanced sentence:

One action that fits this balanced view:

What I want to practice next:

Practice suggestion

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